Your guide to the clue workshop

ADULT ONLY - contains answers. Keep this guide separate from the eight player sheets.

What this pack includes

Six independent puzzles: two codes, two logic tasks and two routes. They can be used separately or in any order. This is not a complete story-based escape room; there are no physical locks, timer or required room search.

Print and prepare

Print the eight player pages single-sided at 100% on matching US Letter paper. One complete player set per team is a starting point. Read this six-page guide on screen, or print it once. Prepare pencils and scissors. For puzzle 3, cut the eleven crates from player page 5 and place them on player page 4. Print both at 100%; each square is 23 mm. No colour-dependent clue is used.

Choose a starting point

The puzzles are designed for children aged 6-12 with adult help as needed. Reading and experience vary. Inspect the sheets first. Try the loading bay or forest trail first. Puzzle 1 now involves inferring a code from four old records before combining five records to reconstruct a five-stop delivery route. It uses two player pages.

Share the information

For puzzle 4, an adult can cut the three helper clues from beneath the diagram and give one to each player. Leave the parcel picture and question intact. Players tell one another their clues and agree on the parcel. With fewer players, take turns or let the adult read a clue.

Help without giving everything away

Ask players to explain their thinking before checking the answer. Give one hint at a time; allow another attempt before the next hint. The last hint can be very direct. If the group wants to stop, read the explained solution together.

How you may use these files

Print for your own household or the classes you teach. Retain the Paper Adventure credit. Do not resell or republish these PDF files; share the public page link instead. These are original Paper Adventure puzzle materials.

The post office: two-stage solution

01 - The rain-soaked post office

Stage 1 - restore the key

Hint 1: Compare lengths first: a three-shape record needs a three-letter label; a four-shape record needs four letters.

Hint 2: Try a label on A, then use the same shape-letter matches to read B. Does B become one of the other labels?

Hint 3: If A were PALM, B would read MAPL, which is not a label. Try the other four-letter label, then restore the key.

Stage 2 - reconstruct the route

Route hint 1: Find the two stops that must be consecutive. Keep them together when trying different orders; then test PALM two positions before or after POOL.

Route hint 2: PALM cannot be two positions before POOL while satisfying records 1 and 4. The continuous group is POOL, LOOM, PALM.

Route hint 3: The three-stop group must occupy positions 3-5. Compare OAK and MALL in positions 1-2 with record 5 to choose their direction.

Answer: OAK MALL POOL LOOM PALM

Stage 1: A=LAMP, B=PALM, C=MAP, D=OAK. If A were PALM, B would read MAPL, which is not a label. The restored key is diamond=L, triangle=A, star=M, cross=P, circle=O, square=K. Stage 2: record 1 decodes to MALL before PALM; record 3 says POOL immediately before LOOM. Combine POOL-LOOM with record 2. If PALM is two positions before POOL, records 1 and 4 cannot both hold. Therefore the group is POOL-LOOM-PALM. It cannot occupy positions 1-3 because MALL must precede PALM, nor positions 2-4 because OAK and MALL could not be neighbours. It occupies positions 3-5. Record 5 excludes MALL-OAK-POOL-LOOM-PALM. The only route is OAK MALL POOL LOOM PALM. Deliver the final letter to PALM.

The moon-station message

02 - The moon-station message

Hint 1: Try a simple explanation for record 1. Does it also work on record 2? Your rule must explain all three records.

Hint 2: Moving the letters in QXV back three places gives NUS. Compare its order with SUN. Does the same idea explain STAR and UDWV?

Hint 3: Move each received letter back three places, then reverse the whole word. For NFRG, the first step gives KCOD. Reverse those letters to find the meeting point.

Answer: DOCK

The sender reverses a word, then moves every letter forward three places. NOON is unchanged by reversal, so its QRRQ record alone also fits a simple shift. SUN becomes NUS, then QXV, disproving a shift alone. STAR becomes RATS, then UDWV; merely swapping its end letters would instead give UWDV. To decode NFRG, move each letter back three places: N to K, F to C, R to O and G to D. KCOD reversed is DOCK. Enter DOCK to restore communication; the rescue ship will meet you at the dock.

The loading bay: explained moves

03 - The blocked loading bay

Hint 1: X needs a clear lane to the right. D and A are in its way. Think about which empty spaces they need.

Hint 2: From your current position, start by making space with crate A. Follow its printed arrows.

Hint 3: Move A down 1 square.

Answer: X reaches EXIT

One solution from the printed starting layout follows. Each slide may cover several empty squares; the last slide delivers X automatically online. Other legal solutions are accepted.

1. A down 1 square
2. C down 1 square
3. B right 1 square
4. D up 1 square
5. G right 1 square
6. F right 1 square
7. J down 3 squares
8. X left 2 squares
9. F left 1 square
10. I up 4 squares
11. E left 1 square
12. G left 1 square
13. D down 2 squares
14. X right 3 squares
15. I down 1 square
16. B left 1 square
17. C up 1 square
18. X right 1 square

Why it works: some crates must move away and later return. X first moves left so I can travel upward, then returns right. B and C later move back to open the exit. Online hints start from the current layout; these printed moves start from player page 4.

Evidence and trails

04 - The right parcel

Hint 1: A parcel must satisfy all three helpers, not just one of them.

Hint 2: Cross out B because its wrapping has dots. Compare the seals and stamp counts on the others.

Hint 3: A has too few stamps and D has the wrong seal. Which parcel is left?

Answer: C

C has stripes, a triangle seal and two stamps. A fails the stamp clue, B fails the wrapping clue and D fails the seal clue. Only C matches all three.

05 - The forest trail

Hint 1: East is right, south is down and west is left. Each move travels exactly one square.

Hint 2: Your first two moves land on B and R. Write those down in that order.

Hint 3: After B and R, move down, left, down and right. Keep one letter from every landing square.

Answer: BRIDGE

The six landing squares give B, R, I, D, G and E. They spell BRIDGE. The starting S is not part of the message.

The harbour crossing

06 - The harbour crossing

Hint 1: Because MILL is forbidden, the first bridge must go from DOCK to OAK.

Hint 2: You must visit BELL and use only three bridges in total. Compare OAK's two onward choices.

Hint 3: The route is DOCK > OAK > BELL > BEACON. Read the numbers on those three bridges in order.

Answer: 258

Avoiding MILL forces DOCK-OAK. To visit BELL within three bridges, continue OAK-BELL-BEACON. The bridge numbers are 2, 5 and 8, giving 258.